

Psalms 5

Morning Prayer

In the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Give ear to my words, O LORD, consider my meditation.
- 2 Hearken unto the voice of my cry, my King, and my God: for unto thee will I pray.
- 3 My voice shalt thou hear in the morning, O LORD; in the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee, and will look up.
- 4 For thou art not a God that hath pleasure in wickedness: neither shall evil dwell with thee.
- 5 The foolish shall not stand in thy sight: thou hatest all workers of iniquity.
- 6 Thou shalt destroy them that speak leasing: the LORD will abhor the bloody and deceitful man.
- 7 But as for me, I will come into thy house in the multitude of thy mercy: and in thy fear will I worship toward thy holy temple.
- 8 Lead me, O LORD, in thy righteousness because of mine enemies; make thy way straight before my face.
- 9 For there is no faithfulness in their mouth; their inward part is very wickedness; their throat is an open sepulchre; they flatter with their tongue.
- 10 Destroy thou them, O God; let them fall by their own counsels; cast them out in the multitude of their transgressions; for they have rebelled against thee.
- 11 But let all those that put their trust in thee rejoice: let them ever shout for joy, because thou defendest them: let them also that love thy name be joyful in thee.
- 12 For thou, LORD, wilt bless the righteous; with favour wilt thou compass him as with a shield.

2 · CONTEXT

A morning prayer of David for guidance amid deceitful enemies. It contrasts God's holiness (no pleasure in wickedness) with the psalmist's approach by mercy into God's house. Henry notes ordered morning prayer and the moral clarity that God opposes the bloody and deceitful while shielding the righteous.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

Urgent, ordered prayer: give ear, consider, hearken. God is King and God. Morning prayer is directed ("I will direct... and will look up")—expectant watching after speaking.

Verse 4-6

Theology of holiness: God takes no pleasure in wickedness; evil cannot dwell with Him; He hates workers of iniquity and abhors the bloody and deceitful. Character shapes hope for justice.

Verse 7-8

The worshiper enters by the multitude of mercy, in fear toward the holy temple, and asks for a straight path because of enemies. Access is mercy; guidance is needed in a hostile setting.

Verse 9-12

Enemies' speech is faithless, flattering, deadly ("open sepulchre"). Imprecation asks God to let their counsel fail. Trusting people rejoice under God's defense; the righteous are compassed with favor as a shield.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Prayer rests on who God is: holy King who hears, rejects evil, and receives the merciful approach of the righteous. Morning order and moral clarity go together; joy belongs to those who take refuge in Him.

Application for life today.

Begin days by directing prayer and looking up, not only checking threats. Let God's holiness correct any casualness about deceit or flattery in your own speech. When opposed by unreliable words, ask for a straight path and for joy rooted in God's shield, not in winning arguments.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would “direct my prayer... and look up” change about your morning routine?

2. Where might flattery or deceit be shaping your relationships—and how does verse 9 warn you?

3. How have you known God’s favor as a “shield,” or where do you need that protection?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).